PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

November 10, 2026
Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center (501 N Dixon St. Portland, OR 97227) and was streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Directors Virginia LaForte (Committee Chair) and Rashelle Chase-Miller; and Board Vice-Chair Michelle DePass

Staff
Jennifer Eggars – Principal of Structural Engineering, Holmes
Jon Franco – Senior Chief Operations
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Counsel
Sarah Norman – Interim Senior Chief, Office of School Modernization
Tom Odgers – Chief of Integrated Operations
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer

Call to Order and Introductions

Director DePass requested that the update on the Center for Black Student Excellence due diligence be moved off of the agenda, and instead have it be a full Board discussion at the November 18th Work Session, where it is on the agenda. The Committee discussed the reasons behind the topic being added late to the agenda which resulted in inadequate notice to interested community members who would want to attend. Committee Chair La Forte stated she would consider the request.

Public Comment

- Collin Harris: A parent in the southwest community who shared concerns about the safety of the schools in their catchment area and the proposed plan outlined in the Holmes Report.
- Daniel LoFaro: Reike parent who shared he has concerns for the seismic safety of schools and asked that the district move quickly to identify a plan to reinforce schools.
- Sylvan Cambier: Rose City Park parent who stated she wants to be included in planning for seismic upgrades.
- Per Olstad: Safe Structures PDX would like visibility to the formula for identifying the schools for seismic upgrades.
- Terrell Garrett: Advocated to require waste recycling into the contract language for school modernizations.
- Arielle Tozier de la Poterie: Cesar Chavez parent who would like visibility to the formula for identifying the schools for seismic upgrades
- Aryn Frazier: Executive Director for the Center for Black Excellence shared she was excited the due diligence period for the One North building is complete. She asked the Board to please move forward with the building.

Director Chase-Miller stated was also in support of postponing the discussion about the due diligence report for the One North building to the upcoming Work Session.

Seismic Update

Jon Franco provided an update on the framework for prioritization using the hybrid approach to updating buildings, including full and partial retrofits. Jennifer Eggers shared the formula for the weighted scoring model. The Committee had questions about how enrollment and equity were considered. Vice-Chair Michelle DePass asked if geological data such as liquefaction zones could be considered and Director Rashelle Chase-Miller asked whether the seismic safety of a building will be considered when considering consolidations. There were questions about the differences in safety between 9 and 9.9.

Facilities Maintenance Staff Analysis

Tom Odgers provided an update on staffing for maintenance positions and shared we are currently 36 short of the recommended number of custodians per square feet. He shared district comparators on work order completion rates. There were questions about what kind of work orders fall to the bottom of the priority list and whether there are ways to engage students or the community to be able to tackle some projects if appropriate.

Grant Bowl Field Lighting Update

Tom Odgers shared that the permit is almost complete and will be finalized and submitted, the equipment is ordered and is scheduled for delivery in January, and the lights will be up in March. He stated the project is 100% bond funded, and Director La Forte stated that the community has fundraised to contribute and it needs to be used for that purpose.

Update on $20M allocated for HVAC improvements

Tom Odgers provided an update on the Portland Clean Energy Community Benefits Fund (PCEF) funds. He provided an overview of where the District is utilizing the funds. There were questions about the timeline and working with the Portland Association of Teachers.

Update on the Request for Proposals for Bond Management

Liz Large shared that there were three proposals received and it was expected that a decision would be made the following week. The next step would be contract negotiations before it goes to the Board for approval.

Update on Center for Black Student Excellence Due Diligence

Director La Forte stated her frustration with not being able to get the Center for Black Student Excellence on the agenda earlier and not being informed that Board Leadership had decided it should be moved to a work session. She stated willingness to move it off of the agenda and wait until the Work Session to have the update.

Future Agenda Topics and Next Steps

There was a request for the Committee to tour Jefferson High School and to discuss Roosevelt Facilities.

Adjournment

Director La Forte adjourned the meeting at 6:12 pm.

Submitted by:
Rosanne Powell
Senior Manager, Board of Education
Portland Public Schools
